

Hands-on Activity 4.2 Transfer Learning on PyTorch	
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1. Discussion	
This activity aims to demonstrate the use of PyTorch in transfer learning to solve a given problem.	
2. Materials and Equipment	
Google Colaboratory hymenoptera _data	
3. Procedure	
Load Important Libraries Load Data Basic Visualization Model Training' Prediction Visualization Training and Evaluation Using ConvNet as fixed feature extractor	
4. Output	
<pre> !nvidia-smi Fri Mar 6 09:38:51 2026 +-----+ NVIDIA-SMI 580.82.07 Driver Version: 580.82.07 CUDA Version: 13.0 +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+ GPU Name Persistence-M Bus-Id Disp.A Volatile Uncorr. ECC Fan Temp Perf Pwr:Usage/Cap Memory-Usage GPU-Util Compute M. MIG M. +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+ 0 Tesla T4 Off 00000000:00:04.0 Off 0 0 N/A 68C P8 11W / 70W 0MiB / 15360MiB 0% Default +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+ +-----+ Processes: GPU GI CI PID Type Process name GPU Memory ID ID ID Usage +-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+ No running processes found +-----+ </pre>	

```
# License: BSD
# Author: Sasank Chilamkurthy

import torch
import torch.nn as nn
import torch.optim as optim
from torch.optim import lr_scheduler
import torch.backends.cudnn as cudnn
import numpy as np
import torchvision
from torchvision import datasets, models, transforms
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import time
import os
from PIL import Image
from tempfile import TemporaryDirectory

cudnn.benchmark = True
plt.ion() # interactive mode

<contextlib.ExitStack at 0x7e70e16c3530>
```

Load Data

=====

We will use torchvision and torch.utils.data packages for loading the data.

The problem we're going to solve today is to train a model to classify **ants** and **bees**. We have about 120 training images each for ants and bees. There are 75 validation images for each class. Usually, this is a very small dataset to generalize upon, if trained from scratch. Since we are using transfer learning, we should be able to generalize reasonably well.

This dataset is a very small subset of imagenet.

```
!rm -R /content/hymenoptera_data/train/.ipynb_checkpoints
!ls /content/hymenoptera_data/test/train -a #to make sure that the deletion has occurred

!rm -R /content/hymenoptera_data/val/.ipynb_checkpoints
!ls /content/hymenoptera_data/val -a #to make sure that the deletion has occurred

rm: cannot remove '/content/hymenoptera_data/train/.ipynb_checkpoints': No such file or directory
ls: cannot access '/content/hymenoptera_data/test/train': No such file or directory
rm: cannot remove '/content/hymenoptera_data/val/.ipynb_checkpoints': No such file or directory
ls: cannot access '/content/hymenoptera_data/val': No such file or directory
```

```
# Data augmentation and normalization for training
# Just normalization for validation
data_transforms = {
    'train': transforms.Compose([
        transforms.RandomSizeCrop(224),
        transforms.RandomHorizontalFlip(),
        transforms.ToTensor(),
        transforms.Normalize([0.485, 0.456, 0.406], [0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
    ]),
    'val': transforms.Compose([
        transforms.Resize(256),
        transforms.CenterCrop(224),
        transforms.ToTensor(),
        transforms.Normalize([0.485, 0.456, 0.406], [0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
    ])
}

data_dir = '/content/drive/MyDrive/CP 313 - Advanced Machine Learning and Deep Learning/hands-on Activity 4.2 Transfer Learning on PyTorch/hymenoptera_data'
image_datasets = {x: datasets.ImageFolder(os.path.join(data_dir, x),
                                              data_transforms[x])
                  for x in ['train', 'val']}
dataloaders = {x: torch.utils.data.DataLoader(image_datasets[x], batch_size=4,
                                              shuffle=True, num_workers=4)
              for x in ['train', 'val']}
dataset_sizes = {x: len(image_datasets[x]) for x in ['train', 'val']}
class_names = image_datasets['train'].classes

# We want to be able to train our model on an 'accelerator' <https://pytorch.org/docs/stable/torch.html#accelerators>
# such as CUDA, MPS, MTKA, or XPU. If the current accelerator is available, we will use it. Otherwise, we use the CPU.
device = torch.accelerator.current_accelerator().type if torch.accelerator.is_available() else 'cpu'
print(f"Using cuda device")

Using cuda device
/usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-packages/torch/utils/data/dataloader.py:432: UserWarning: This DataLoader will create 4 worker processes in total. Our suggested max number of worker in current system is 2, which is small
self.check_worker_number_rationality()
```

Visualize a few images

=====

Let's visualize a few training images so as to understand the data augmentations.

[8]
✓ 2s

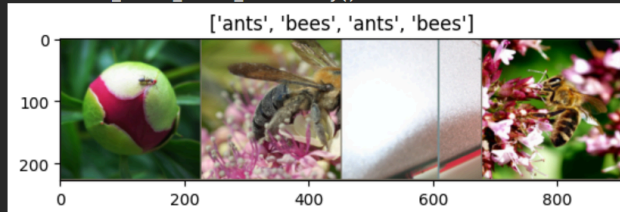
```
def imshow(inp, title=None):
    """Display image for Tensor."""
    inp = inp.numpy().transpose((1, 2, 0))
    mean = np.array([0.485, 0.456, 0.406])
    std = np.array([0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
    inp = std * inp + mean
    inp = np.clip(inp, 0, 1)
    plt.imshow(inp)
    if title is not None:
        plt.title(title)
    plt.pause(0.001) # pause a bit so that plots are updated

# Get a batch of training data
inputs, classes = next(iter(dataloaders['train']))

# Make a grid from batch
out = torchvision.utils.make_grid(inputs)

imshow(out, title=[class_names[x] for x in classes])
```

... /usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-packages/torch/utils/data/dataloader.py:432: UserWarning: This DataLoader will create 4 worker processes in total. Our suggested max number of worker in current system is 2, which is small
self.check_worker_number_rationality()



▼ Training the model

=====

Now, let's write a general function to train a model. Here, we will illustrate:

- Scheduling the learning rate
- Saving the best model

In the following, parameter `scheduler` is an LR scheduler object from `torch.optim.lr_scheduler`.

```
def train_model(model, criterion, optimizer, scheduler, num_epochs=25):
    since = time.time()

    # Create a temporary directory to save training checkpoints
    with TemporaryDirectory() as tempdir:
        best_model_params_path = os.path.join(tempdir, 'best_model_params.pt')

        torch.save(model.state_dict(), best_model_params_path)
        best_acc = 0.0

        for epoch in range(num_epochs):
            print(f'Epoch {epoch}/{num_epochs - 1}')
            print('-' * 10)

            # Each epoch has a training and validation phase
            for phase in ['train', 'val']:
                if phase == 'train':
                    model.train() # Set model to training mode
                else:
                    model.eval() # Set model to evaluate mode

                running_loss = 0.0
                running_corrects = 0

                # Iterate over data.
                for inputs, labels in dataloaders[phase]:
                    inputs = inputs.to(device)
                    labels = labels.to(device)

                    # zero the parameter gradients
                    optimizer.zero_grad()
```

```

        # forward
        # track history if only in train
        with torch.set_grad_enabled(phase == 'train'):
            outputs = model(inputs)
            _, preds = torch.max(outputs, 1)
            loss = criterion(outputs, labels)

        # backward + optimize only if in training phase
        if phase == 'train':
            loss.backward()
            optimizer.step()

        # statistics
        running_loss += loss.item() * inputs.size(0)
        running_corrects += torch.sum(preds == labels.data)
    if phase == 'train':
        scheduler.step()

    epoch_loss = running_loss / dataset_sizes[phase]
    epoch_acc = running_corrects.double() / dataset_sizes[phase]

    print(f'{phase} Loss: {epoch_loss:.4f} Acc: {epoch_acc:.4f}')

    # deep copy the model
    if phase == 'val' and epoch_acc > best_acc:
        best_acc = epoch_acc
        torch.save(model.state_dict(), best_model_params_path)

    print()

    time_elapsed = time.time() - since
    print(f'Training complete in {time_elapsed // 60:.0f}m {time_elapsed % 60:.0f}s')
    print(f'Best val Acc: {best_acc:4f}')

    # load best model weights
    model.load_state_dict(torch.load(best_model_params_path, weights_only=True))
return model

```

Visualizing the model predictions

=====

Generic function to display predictions for a few images

```
[10]
✓ 0s
def visualize_model(model, num_images=6):
    was_training = model.training
    model.eval()
    images_so_far = 0
    fig = plt.figure()

    with torch.no_grad():
        for i, (inputs, labels) in enumerate(dataloaders['val']):
            inputs = inputs.to(device)
            labels = labels.to(device)

            outputs = model(inputs)
            _, preds = torch.max(outputs, 1)

            for j in range(inputs.size()[0]):
                images_so_far += 1
                ax = plt.subplot(num_images//2, 2, images_so_far)
                ax.axis('off')
                ax.set_title(f'predicted: {class_names[preds[j]]}')
                imshow(inputs.cpu().data[j])

            if images_so_far == num_images:
                model.train(mode=was_training)
                return
    model.train(mode=was_training)
```

Finetuning the ConvNet

=====

Load a pretrained model and reset final fully connected layer.

```
[11]
✓ 0s
model_ft = models.resnet18(weights='IMAGENET1K_V1')
num_ftrs = model_ft.fc.in_features
# Here the size of each output sample is set to 2.
# Alternatively, it can be generalized to ``nn.Linear(num_ftrs, len(class_names))``.
model_ft.fc = nn.Linear(num_ftrs, 2)

model_ft = model_ft.to(device)

criterion = nn.CrossEntropyLoss()

# Observe that all parameters are being optimized
optimizer_ft = optim.SGD(model_ft.parameters(), lr=0.001, momentum=0.9)

# Decay LR by a factor of 0.1 every 7 epochs
exp_lr_scheduler = lr_scheduler.StepLR(optimizer_ft, step_size=7, gamma=0.1)

Downloading: "https://download.pytorch.org/models/resnet18-f37072fd.pth" to /root/.cache/torch/hub/checkpoints/resnet18-f37072fd.pth
100%|██████████| 44.7M/44.7M [00:00<00:00, 208MB/s]
```

✓ Train and evaluate

=====

It should take around 15-25 min on CPU. On GPU though, it takes less than a minute.

```
[12] ✓ 2m model_ft = train_model(model_ft, criterion, optimizer_ft, exp_lr_scheduler,  
                                num_epochs=25)
```

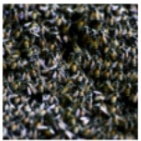
```
✓ Epoch 0/24  
-----  
train Loss: 0.6570 Acc: 0.6926  
val Loss: 0.3359 Acc: 0.8497  
  
Epoch 1/24  
-----  
train Loss: 0.6116 Acc: 0.7746  
val Loss: 0.4281 Acc: 0.8366  
  
Epoch 2/24  
-----  
train Loss: 0.4923 Acc: 0.7992  
val Loss: 0.4223 Acc: 0.8497
```

```
[13] ✓ 1s visualize_model(model_ft)
```

```
✓ ... predicted: bees
```



```
predicted: ants
```



```
predicted: ants
```



```
predicted: ants
```



```
predicted: ants
```



ConvNet as fixed feature extractor

=====

Here, we need to freeze all the network except the final layer. We need to set `requires_grad = False` to freeze the parameters so that the gradients are not computed in `backward()`.

You can read more about this in the documentation [here](#).

```
[14]
✓ 0s
model_conv = torchvision.models.resnet18(weights='IMAGENET1K_V1')
for param in model_conv.parameters():
    param.requires_grad = False

# Parameters of newly constructed modules have requires_grad=True by default
num_fts = model_conv.fc.in_features
model_conv.fc = nn.Linear(num_fts, 2)

model_conv = model_conv.to(device)

criterion = nn.CrossEntropyLoss()

# Observe that only parameters of final layer are being optimized as
# opposed to before.
optimizer_conv = optim.SGD(model_conv.fc.parameters(), lr=0.001, momentum=0.9)

# Decay LR by a factor of 0.1 every 7 epochs
exp_lr_scheduler = lr_scheduler.StepLR(optimizer_conv, step_size=7, gamma=0.1)
```

Train and evaluate

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On CPU this will take about half the time compared to previous scenario. This is expected as gradients don't need to be computed for most of the network. However, forward does need to be computed.

```
[15]
✓ 1m
model_conv = train_model(model_conv, criterion, optimizer_conv,
                        exp_lr_scheduler, num_epochs=25)
```

```

Epoch 14/24
-----
train loss: 0.3298 Acc: 0.8566
val loss: 0.2040 Acc: 0.9281

Epoch 15/24
-----
train loss: 0.3130 Acc: 0.8443
val loss: 0.2092 Acc: 0.9412

Epoch 16/24
```



```
[16] visualize_model(model_conv)
0s
plt.ioff()
plt.show()
```

... predicted: ants



predicted: ants



predicted: ants



predicted: bees



▼ Inference on custom images

=====

Use the trained model to make predictions on custom images and visualize the predicted class labels along with the images.

```
[17]
✓ 0s
def visualize_model_predictions(model,img_path):
    was_training = model.training
    model.eval()

    img = Image.open(img_path)
    img = data_transforms['val'](img)
    img = img.unsqueeze(0)
    img = img.to(device)

    with torch.no_grad():
        outputs = model(img)
        _, preds = torch.max(outputs, 1)

    ax = plt.subplot(2,2,1)
    ax.axis('off')
    ax.set_title(f'Predicted: {class_names[preds[0]]}')
    imshow(img.cpu().data[0])

    model.train(mode=was_training)
```